

Those family members who had bought a plot of land for pennies essentially bought them before stage 1. As they bought it and forgot the purchase for decades, it allowed the greater municipality to expand the city's perimeter. This meant that the land could increase in value through all the stages. But most primarily, it had the multiple growth available within stage 1 and stage 2. But if you're going to buy apartments at an already posh location in the city, it means you've skipped stage 1-3 and are banking on stage 4 and 5 for price appreciation. Now, if you buy an apartment in an established environment, you can't even get lucky with timing. Your returns will barely beat inflation (i.e. 6-8%) as the price people can afford is the increase in their salaries.

After reading this line of reasoning, people will most likely shoot me down on twitter or send a barrage of emails on how they're different. Any unique prima donna case will have lower interest rates, greater flexibility on EMI payments or a higher salary taken home. To nip any such advances, the above narration is for a larger audience (single, unmarried and no responsibility youngsters who prefer flexibility to security) and meant to be an eye-opening exercise. Being in denial because you've already bought a home or arguing that I'm totally wrong will not be productive. I like to think of myself as Samwell Baggins to you, Mr. Frodo. Whatever decision you take, I'll be with you and help you see clearly.

Given these factors, it makes **NO SENSE** ^[25] to buy a property as an investment. Buying a house to stay in is an expense - a really huge expense. When you start pivoting your idea of a home as an expense instead of an investment the whole earth beneath you shifts. The math will become more important and the emotions will take a back-seat. Any appreciation that the house obtains during the time you gestate is a lucky break. With inflation jamming on us hard, lucky breaks are not ideal ^[26] - we need assured solutions.

But, if you feel you have to buy a home, here are a couple of factors to help you make the decision:

Factor #1: Before you decide to throw money on rent forever, or pay 'EMI's and expenses' forever, consider how effective both renting and